LEITER it has been released. The record was produced by US-based Pakistani singer-songwriter Arooj Aftab with whom Shankar recorded the Grammy-nominated duet 'Udhero Na', for the deluxe edition of Aftab's album *Vulture Prince*.

Shankar shares that there are two key things that make her want to work with somebody. "It's very similar to romantic attraction, just not in a romantic sense," she says. "Their art speaks to me deeply, and it's art that I want to be inside of musically. The next component is that it has to feel the same with the person. They have to be someone I can connect with and have fun with. Over the years, I've grown to trust that attraction and that intuition because, so far, my experience is that if I'm pulled towards their work and I like them as a person, we're always able to work together."

Among her previous collaborators is Sting, who is also playing Lollapalooza, but Shankar declines to reveal whether they will guest during either's performances. "You're not the first person to think of it but even if it was happening, I couldn't say anything," she says with a laugh. ■

–Amit Gurbaxani

Tickets for Anoushka Shankar's 2024 India tour are being sold on Bookmyshow.com

PREVIEW

We Will Rock You

Lollapalooza India is back for a second edition in Mumbai with some great musical acts

In 1991, American alternative rock act Jane's Addiction were contemplating the end of the band's short but hugely influential first run. Frontman Perry Farrell put together a farewell tour—named Lollapalooza after an American idiomatic phrase meaning "an extraordinary or unusual thing, person, or event"—as a way to celebrate the band's legacy. The tour's lineup—featuring alt-rock icons Siouxsie and the Banshees, industrial music titan Nine Inch Nails and Ice T's cop-baiting rap-metal act Body Count—represented a cross-section of acts that existed outside of the mainstream status quo. As a farewell, it had mixed success: Farrell and guitarist David Navarro got into a fight on-stage at the very first Lollapalooza show. But as a tour it was a smash hit, spawning a music festival that has run for over 30 years—barring a small hiatus in the late '90s and early Naughties—and become one of the world's biggest live music events.

On January 27 and 28, Lollapalooza will return to the Mahalaxmi Racecourse grounds in Mumbai for the global festival's second Indian edition. This year's lineup includes a mix of guaranteed crowd-pleasers (Sting, Jonas Brothers), indie gems (Royal Blood, Caribou) and avant-garde weirdos (JPEGMAFIA). With 35 artists across four stages, there's plenty to choose from, and lots of exciting new music to experience. Here's our list of five must-catch acts at Lollapalooza India 2024.

❶ Halsey

Sure, Sting is the big pop headliner and pretty much everyone will be at his stage come set time, but do make sure to also catch gender-fluid pop rebel Halsey. Her 2021 record *If I Can't Have Love, I Want Power*—a concept album about "the joys and horrors of childbirth" was nominated for the Best Alternative Music Album Grammy.

This year, the festival features crowdpleasers like **STING** and the **JONAS BROTHERS**

❷ Royal Blood

This Brighton rock duo rose to stardom with their self-titled 2014 debut album, centred on bass, drums, angst and stoner blues. They have added a little more dancefloor magic to their toolkit in the years since, but they remain a big loud rock act at heart.

❸ JPEGMAFIA

Baltimore avant-garde guerrilla JPEGMAFIA is one of the most exciting voices in contemporary hip-hop, bringing together noise, trap and R&B in a thrillingly eccentric musical melange.

❹ The Rose

The South Korean rockers are coming off a marquee 2023, with their latest pop-punk album *Dual* debuting at #83 on the Billboard 200, a successful world tour, and much talked about sets at major festivals. Turns out there's more to South Korea than just K-Pop.

❺ Fatoumata Diawara

This Malian singer-songwriter takes the Wassoulou musical traditions of southern Mali and gives them a global makeover. Her music is Afro-futurist, in the best way, all graceful style and joyful exuberance. ■

–Bhanuj Kappal









YASH BHANUSHALI

THE BANDS' VISIT (Clockwise from right) The Rose; crowds at the fest in 2023; JPEGMAFIA and Fatoumata Diawara